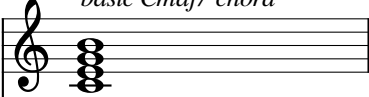
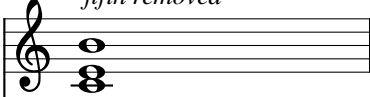
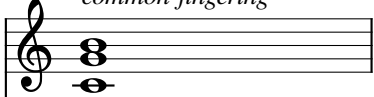
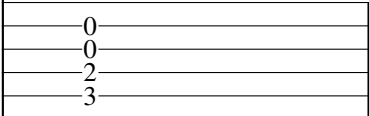
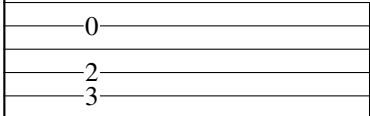
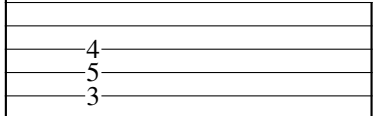


Shell Voicings

"Shell Voicings" are shortened four-note chords. A four note chord consists of Root, 3rd, 5th and 7th. Usually the fifth is removed from a shell chord voicing as it is not relevant to the sound the basic seventh chord. This results in fairly easy chord types that are ideal for accompanying Jazz and Bossa Nova songs.

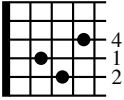
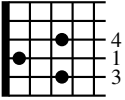
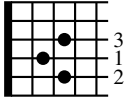
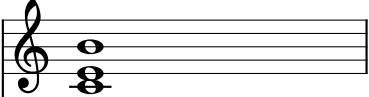
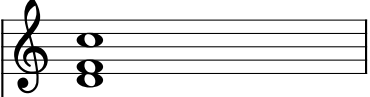
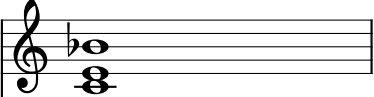
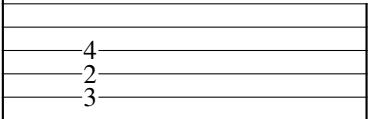
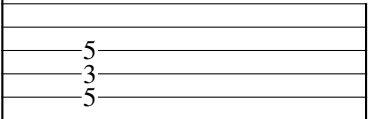
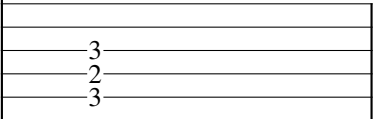
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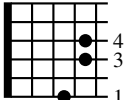
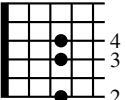
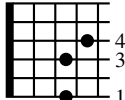
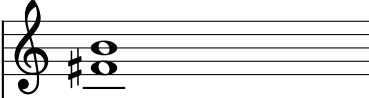
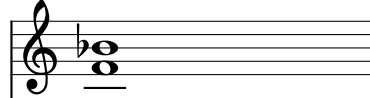
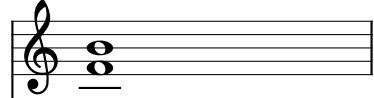
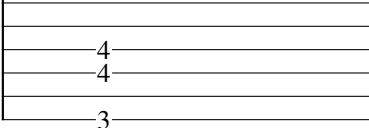
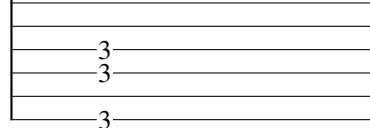
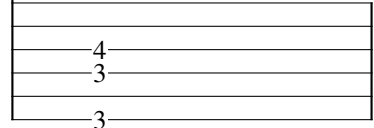
As you can see in the notation below, the construction of a shell voicing is simple. The fifth is removed and the fingering is adapted to be useful all around the neck.

<i>basic Cmaj7 chord</i>	<i>fifth removed</i>	<i>common fingering</i>
		
		

The Common Shell Voicings

Familiarize yourself with the six most common Shell Voicings. The fingerings indicated next to the chord diagrams are only a suggestion and may not always be the best solution.

CMaj7	Cm7	C7
		
		
		

GMaj7	Gm7	G7
		
		
		

Shell Voicings: Exercises

Here are some common exercises to familiarize yourself with these chords, and to train your muscle memory.

Play the chords as if they were a scale, up and down the neck. Here is the C-Major Scale in Shell Voicings with the **Root Note on the A-String**:

CMaj7 Dm7 Em7 FMaj7 G7 Am7 Bm7 CMaj7

4	5	7	9	10	12	14	16
2	3	5	7	9	10	12	14
3	5	7	8	10	12	14	15

The same exercise in F-Major with the **The Root Note on the E-String**:

FMaj7 Gm7 Am7 BbMaj7 C7 Dm7 Em7 FMaj7

2	3	5	7	9	10	12	14
2	3	5	7	8	10	12	14
1	3	5	6	8	10	12	13

A very common chord progression in Jazz and Bossa Nova songs is **The Turnaround** (or the "I-VI-II-V"). In C-Major this chord progression is: **C (I) - Am (VI) - Dm (II) - G (V)**. Here is how it looks with Shell Voicings:

CMaj7 Am7 Dm7 G7

4	5	5	4
2	5	3	3
3	5	5	3

Play through the variations of **The Turnaround** on the next page to get fluid with these useful guitar chords!

Shell Voicings: The Turnaround

Basic Turnaround in C-Major and F-Major:

Diagram illustrating the Basic Turnaround in C-Major and F-Major, showing chord voicings and corresponding bass line fingerings.

C-Major and F-Major Turnaround:

Chords: CMaj7, Am7, Dm7, G7, FMaj7, Dm7, Gm7, C7.

Fingerings (Bass Line):

- CMaj7: 2, 4, 5, 3
- Am7: 5, 5, 3, 5
- Dm7: 3, 5, 3, 5
- G7: 3, 4, 3, 3
- FMaj7: 2, 2, 1, 3
- Dm7: 5, 3, 3, 3
- Gm7: 3, 3, 3, 3
- C7: 2, 3, 2, 3

Turnaround starting on the subdominant (II) chord:

Diagram illustrating the Turnaround starting on the subdominant (II) chord, showing chord voicings and corresponding bass line fingerings.

Subdominant Turnaround:

Chords: Dm7, G7, CMaj7, Am7, Gm7, C7, FMaj7, Dm7.

Fingerings (Bass Line):

- Dm7: 3, 5, 3, 5
- G7: 3, 4, 3, 3
- CMaj7: 2, 4, 2, 3
- Am7: 5, 5, 3, 5
- Gm7: 3, 3, 3, 3
- C7: 2, 2, 2, 3
- FMaj7: 2, 2, 1, 3
- Dm7: 3, 5, 3, 5

Turnaround with secondary dominant (VIIm = V17):

Diagram illustrating the Turnaround with secondary dominant (VIIm = V17), showing chord voicings and corresponding bass line fingerings.

Secondary Dominant Turnaround:

Chords: Dm7, G7, CMaj7, A7, Am7, D7, GMaj7, E7.

Fingerings (Bass Line):

- Dm7: 3, 5, 3, 5
- G7: 3, 4, 3, 3
- CMaj7: 2, 4, 2, 3
- A7: 5, 6, 5, 5
- Am7: 5, 5, 3, 5
- D7: 4, 4, 4, 5
- GMaj7: 3, 4, 4, 3
- E7: 6, 7, 6, 7

Turnaround without resolution to the Tonic (I) chord (II-V-III-VI):

Diagram illustrating the Turnaround without resolution to the Tonic (I) chord (II-V-III-VI), showing chord voicings and corresponding bass line fingerings.

Non-Resolving Turnaround:

Chords: Dm7, G7, Em7, A7, Gm7, C7, Am7, D7.

Fingerings (Bass Line):

- Dm7: 3, 5, 3, 5
- G7: 3, 4, 3, 3
- Em7: 5, 7, 5, 5
- A7: 5, 6, 5, 5
- Gm7: 3, 3, 3, 3
- C7: 2, 2, 2, 3
- Am7: 5, 5, 5, 3
- D7: 4, 5, 4, 5